

How a Starting Wage is Built

A starting wage for an hourly team member is built like this:

- Statutory minimum wage is the minimum required by your state or local government to pay someone.
- Panera minimum wage is the amount Panera decides should be the minimum at each cafe for RTMs.
- Your Retail Team Member average pay – is what current hourly team members are making.
- And the Panera maximum – is the cap amount to be paid as an hourly team member.

Think of these as building blocks as we build this cafe... literally!

- We'll start at the street level. This is the statutory minimum wage level ... we can't go any lower than the street!
- To get the RTM Panera minimum... we'll build our cafe on top of the street.
- The people placed in the cafe are your current RTMs and their average pay to consider.
- ... and then the maximum is our roof. We can't go higher than the roof, right?

Knowing how a starting wage is built will help you understand how to determine one for a new hire, but how do you find this info?

Answer... it's all about knowing your wage zone.